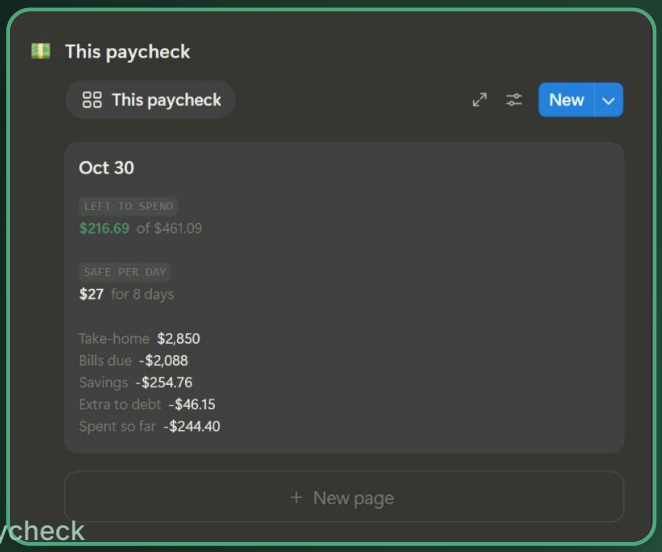
Northline Budget

Paycheck OS

The complete user guide. Every page, every card and every list, explained in order.

Setup in about 10 minutes



Notion budget planner · works paycheck by paycheck

What is inside

Read it front to back once, then keep it as a reference.

1 How Paycheck OS works

2 Your first 10 minutes: setup step by step

3 The Overview page and its menu

4 This paycheck: your main number

5 By category and Month by month

6 Bills: pay from this paycheck, Log payment, Subscriptions

7 Spending: logging, last 7 days, Where it went, calendar

8 Category budgets and Budget split

9 Income and Accounts

10 Savings goals and Debt payoff

11 Asset allocation and Holdings

12 Your data: every database and every field

13 Routines: every payday, every bill, every day

14 Logging from your phone

15 Questions and fixes

Free and full version. Paycheck OS Free has the paycheck planner: My plan, Paychecks, Bills, Spending and a fixed amount for savings and extra debt. Sections marked Full version are only in Paycheck OS ($29).

Chapter 1

How Paycheck OS works

Most budgets think in months. Your money arrives in paychecks. Paycheck OS plans each paycheck on its own.

Every time you get paid, Paycheck OS looks at the time until your next payday and works out:

1. **Take-home**: what landed in your account.
2. **Bills due**: every bill with a due date before your next payday.
3. **Savings**: what to put aside this paycheck for your savings goals.
4. **Extra to debt**: any extra payment you chose on top of your minimum payments.
5. **Spent so far**: everything you logged in Spending since this payday.

What remains is **Left to spend**. Divide it by the days until payday and you get your **Safe per day**: the amount you can spend each day and still reach payday.

Example from the template

Take-home $2,850 − bills due $2,088 − savings $254.76 − extra to debt $46.15 = **$461.09** for this paycheck.

$461.09 − $244.40 already spent = **$216.69 left to spend**. With 8 days to payday that is **$27 a day**.

How the pieces connect

- **My plan** holds your take-home pay, pay frequency and currency. Everything else reads from it.
- **Paychecks** holds one row per payday. Each row does the math above for its own pay period.
- **Bills**, **Spending**, **Savings goals** and **Debts** feed the numbers.
- The **Overview** (the main Paycheck OS page) shows it all as cards. You add data, the cards update by themselves.

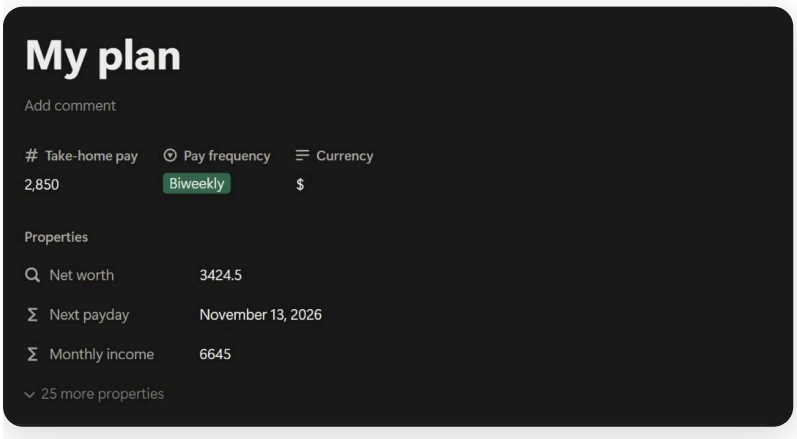
All lists live on one page called **Your data**. You rarely need to open it: the Overview shows what matters, and you can add rows straight from the cards.

Chapter 2

Your first 10 minutes

Do these steps once. After that you only log spending and add a paycheck when you get paid. The same steps are on the Start here page inside the template.

1. **Duplicate the template.** Open the Notion link from your Gumroad receipt and click **Duplicate** at the top right. It is copied into your own Notion workspace. A free Notion account is enough.
2. **Set your pay and currency (2 min).** Open **Your data** → **My plan** and change the one row:
   - **Take-home pay**: what lands in your account each payday, after tax.
   - **Pay frequency**: Weekly, Biweekly, Twice a month or Monthly.
   - **Currency**: type your symbol, for example $, €, £, лв, R$ or ₹. Every card uses it.
3. **Add your bills (3 min).** Open **Your data** → **Bills**. Delete the sample rows and add yours: name, amount and the day of the month it is due. Tick **Autopay** for bills that pay themselves. Choose the category **Subscriptions** for anything that renews.
4. **Add goals and debts (3 min).** In **Savings goals** enter a target, what you already have and the date you need it by. In **Debts** enter balance, interest rate and minimum payment. Add an extra amount per month if you want to pay it off sooner.
5. **Add your paychecks (1 min).** Open **Your data** → **Paychecks**. Add a row for your last payday and one for the next. Name them by date, for example "Nov 13", and set the **Pay date**. Leave **Take-home override** empty unless one paycheck is different.
6. **Optional extras (5 min).** Income, Category budgets, Budget split, Accounts, Holdings and Asset allocation. Skip any you do not need, everything else works without them. Each one is explained in its own chapter.
7. **Delete the samples (1 min).** Remove the sample spending, income, accounts, goals, debts and holdings. The Overview updates on its own.



My plan: the one row that drives everything. Next payday is filled in for you.

Chapter 3

The Overview page and its menu

Open Paycheck OS and you land on the Overview. Everything is on this one page, from top to bottom.

The menu

Menu link	What it opens
Start here	The setup steps, the payday routine and phone tips.
Bills	All your bills with due dates, status and the Log payment button.
Spending	Everything you spent, with date, category and account.
Savings goals Full version	Your goals, progress and the amount to put aside each paycheck.
Debt payoff Full version	Your debts with payoff dates and total interest.
Subscriptions Full version	Bills in the Subscriptions category, sorted by next renewal.
Every paycheck	All paydays with what each one covers. Add a new paycheck here.
Your data	Every database in one place (chapter 12).

The cards, in order

1. This paycheck · By category, last 30 days · Month by month
2. Pay from this paycheck · Subscriptions
3. Spending, last 7 days · Where it went, last 30 days
4. Category budgets, this month · Budget split
5. Income, this month · Accounts
6. Savings goals · Debt payoff
7. Asset allocation · Holdings
8. Spending calendar

The next chapters go through them in exactly this order. Every card is a live view of a database: click **New** to add a row, or click a row to edit it.

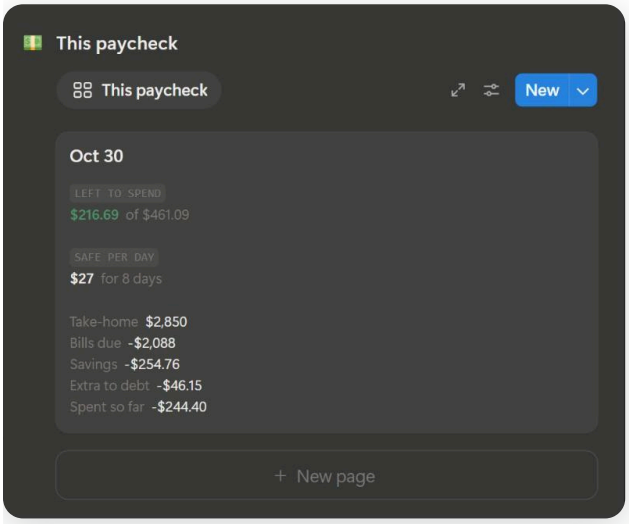
Free version. The menu has Start here and Your data. The page shows This paycheck, Pay from this paycheck, Spending this paycheck and Every paycheck.

Chapter 4

This paycheck

The most important card. It answers one question: how much can I still spend until payday?

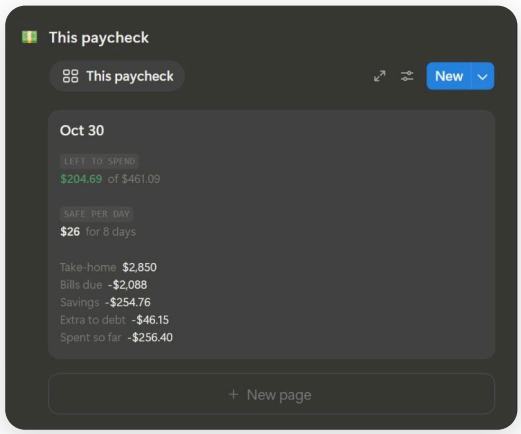
Which paycheck is shown? The card shows the current pay period: the latest paycheck whose pay date is today or earlier. Add each new paycheck when you get paid and the card moves on to it.



Line	Meaning
Left to spend	What remains after bills, savings, extra debt and spending. "of $461.09" is what this paycheck had for spending at the start.
Safe per day	Left to spend divided by the days until next payday.
Take-home	From My plan, or the override on this paycheck.
Bills due	Bills due before next payday.
Savings	Total to put aside for goals this paycheck.
Extra to debt	Your extra debt payments, per paycheck.
Spent so far	Spending logged in this pay period.

It updates as you spend

Log a $12 lunch and the card changes right away: left to spend drops from $216.69 to $204.69 and safe per day from $27 to $26.

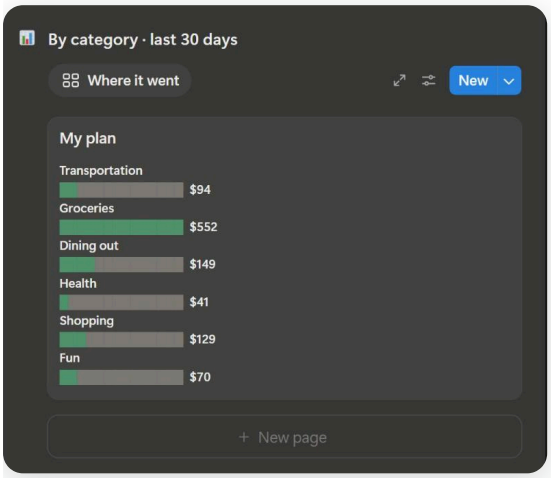


Chapter 5

By category and Month by month

By category · last 30 days Full version

A bar chart of your spending in the last 30 days, one bar per category. Use it to see at a glance where most of your money goes.

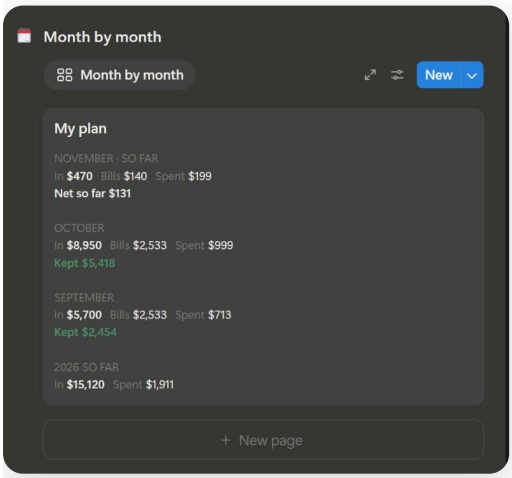


Month by month Full version

One row per month:

- **In**: income logged that month.
- **Bills**: bill payments that month.
- **Spent**: spending that month.
- **Kept**: what was left over. For the current month it shows **Net so far**.

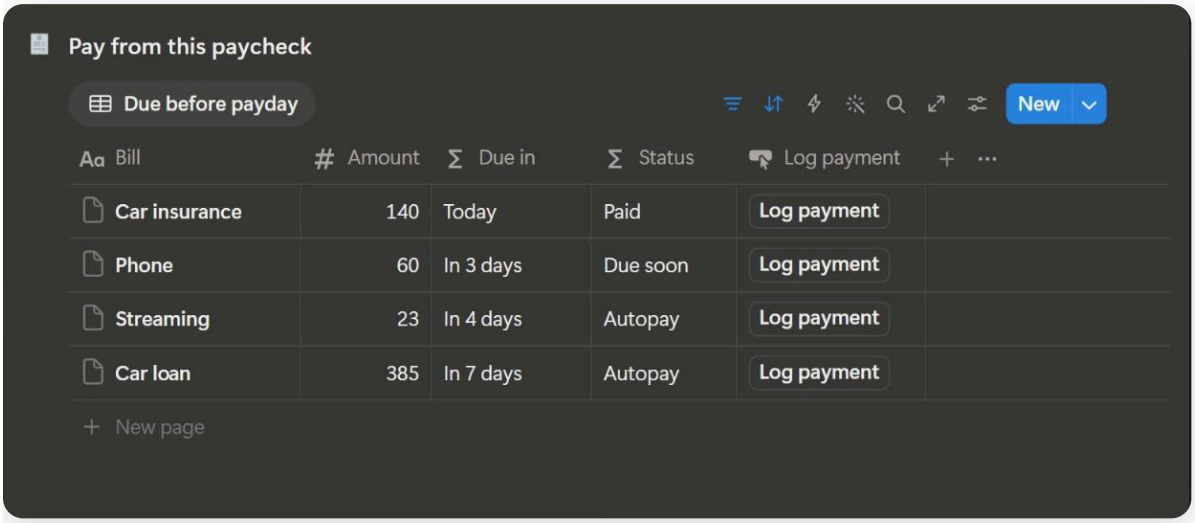
The last row adds up the year so far.



Chapter 6

Bills

Pay from this paycheck lists every bill due before your next payday, soonest first.

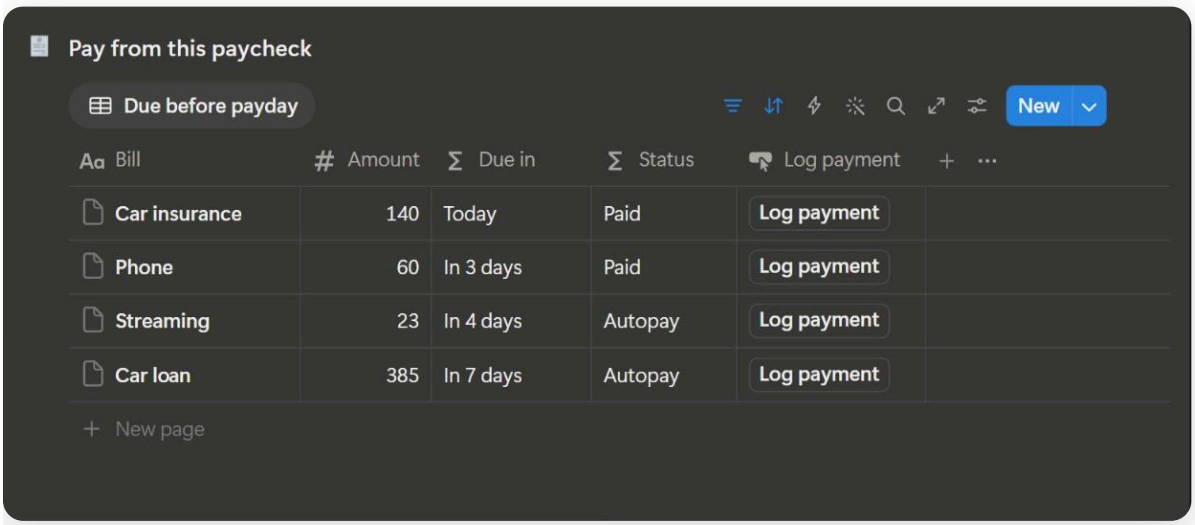


Status labels

Status	Meaning
Autopay	You ticked Autopay. It pays itself, nothing to do.
Due soon	Due in the next few days. Pay it now.
Scheduled	Due later in this pay period.
Paid	You logged a payment for this due date.

Log payment Full version

When you pay a bill, click **Log payment** on its row. Paycheck OS records the payment with today's date in Bill payments and marks the bill **Paid** until its next due date.

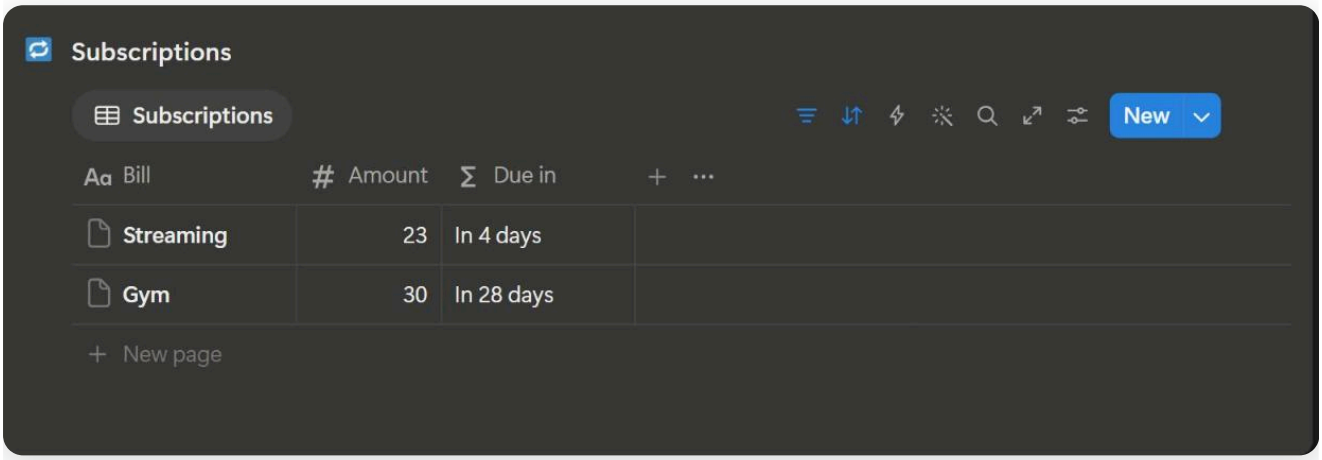


Bill fields

Amount, **Due day** (1 to 31), **Autopay** and **Category**: Housing, Utilities, Transportation, Insurance, Phone & internet, Subscriptions, Debt payment or Other. Next due date, days until due and status are worked out for you.

Subscriptions Full version

Every bill with the category **Subscriptions** also shows in this card, with the days until it renews. Nothing renews without you noticing.



Chapter 7

Spending

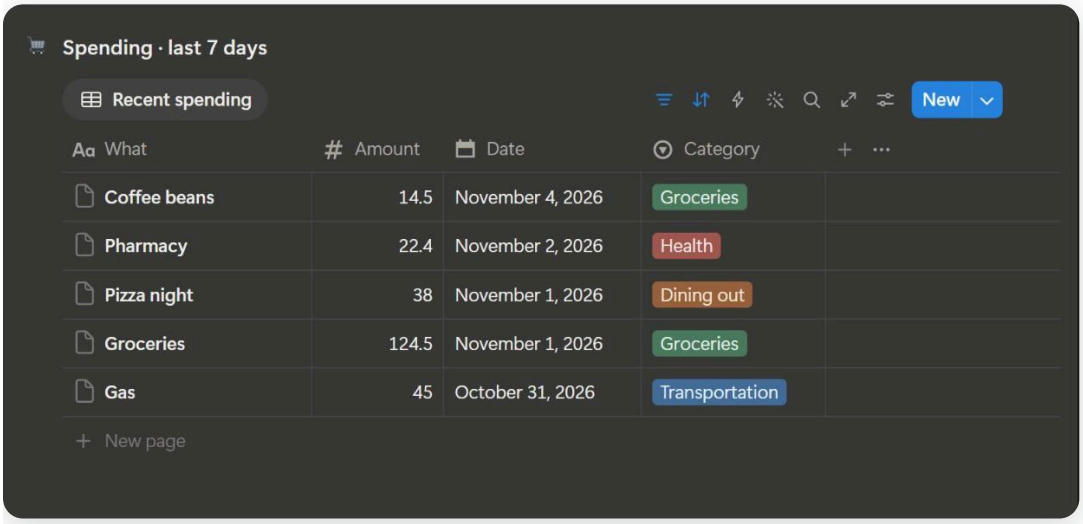
Log what you spend and every card updates: this paycheck, budgets, charts and accounts.

Log a purchase

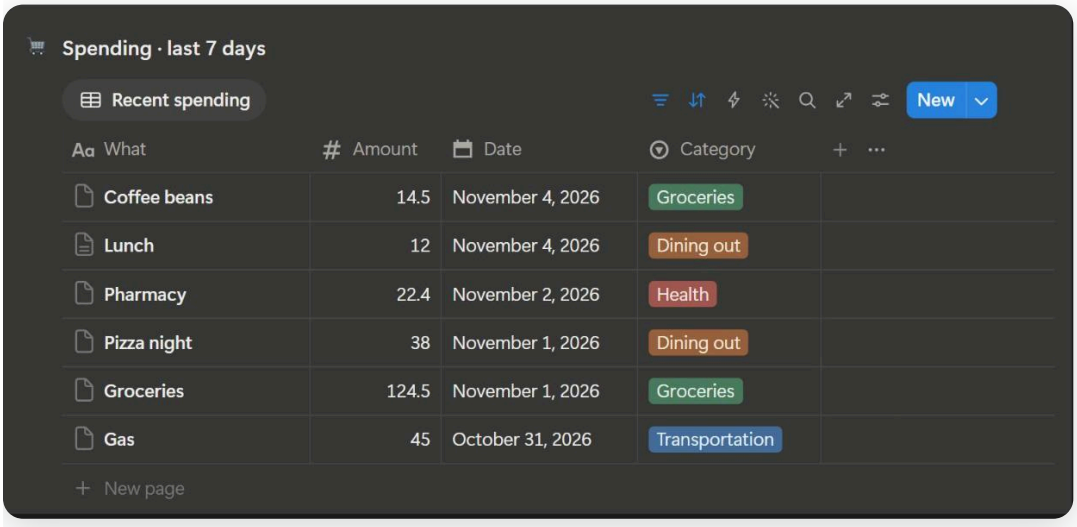
1. Click **New** on the Spending card.
2. Type what it was, for example "Lunch", and the amount.
3. Pick a category. Today's date is filled in for you.
4. Optional: pick the account you paid from (Full version).

Spending · last 7 days

In the free version this card is called Spending this paycheck.



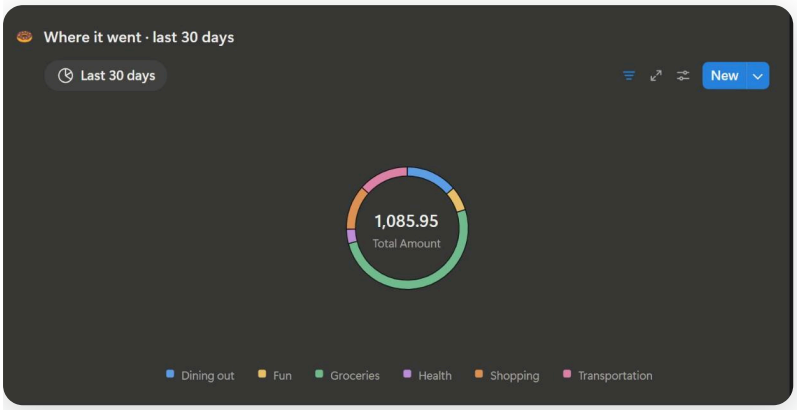
After adding "Lunch 12" the new row appears at the top with today's date:



Spending categories: Groceries, Dining out, Transportation, Shopping, Health, Fun, Kids and Other.

Where it went · last 30 days Full version

A donut chart of the last 30 days by category, with the total in the middle.



Spending calendar Full version

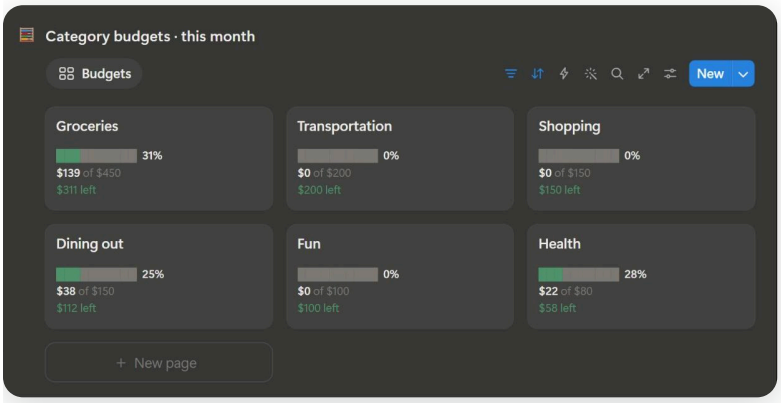
The last card on the Overview shows every purchase on a month calendar. Use it to spot expensive days and weekends.

Chapter 8

Category budgets and Budget split

Category budgets · this month Full version

Set a monthly limit per spending category. Each bar shows what you spent this month, the percentage used and what is left.



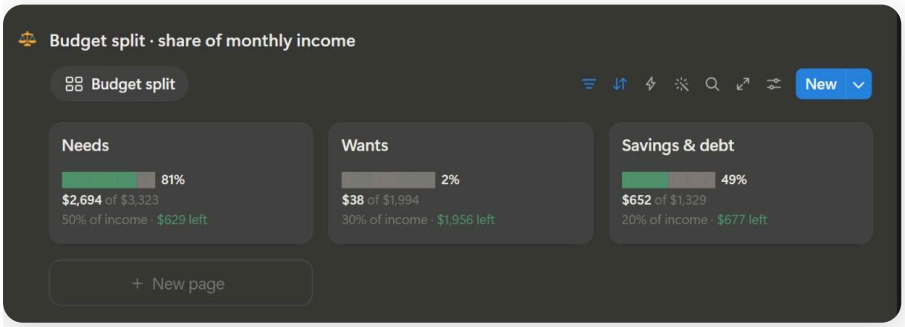
Important. The name of each budget row must match a Spending category exactly, for example "Dining out", not "Dining". Otherwise it stays at $0.

Budget split · share of monthly income Full version

Split your monthly income into pillars, for example the 50/30/20 rule:

- **Needs 50%**: bills and groceries.
- **Wants 30%**: dining out, shopping, fun.
- **Savings & debt 20%**: savings and extra debt payments.

For each pillar, set **Share of income** (the shares should add up to 100) and choose in **Includes** what counts toward it: Bills, Savings, Extra to debt or any spending category. The card shows what you used against the pillar's budget this month.



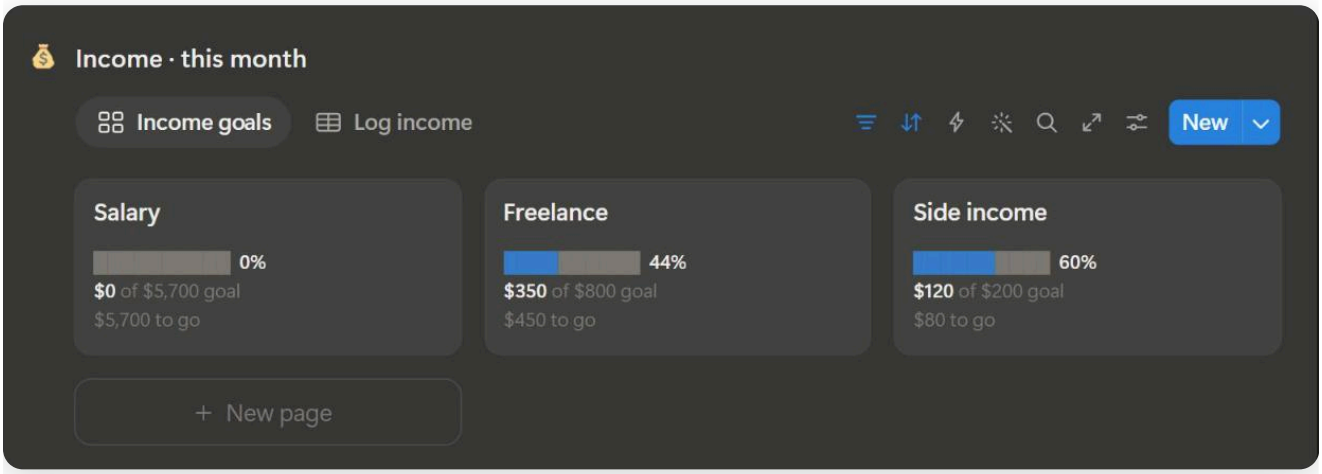
Chapter 9

Income and Accounts

Income · this month Full version

Log each paycheck and any side income in **Income**: what, amount, date, source and, optionally, the account it went into. You can attach an invoice file to freelance income.

In **Income sources** set a monthly goal per source. The card shows how much you earned this month against each goal.

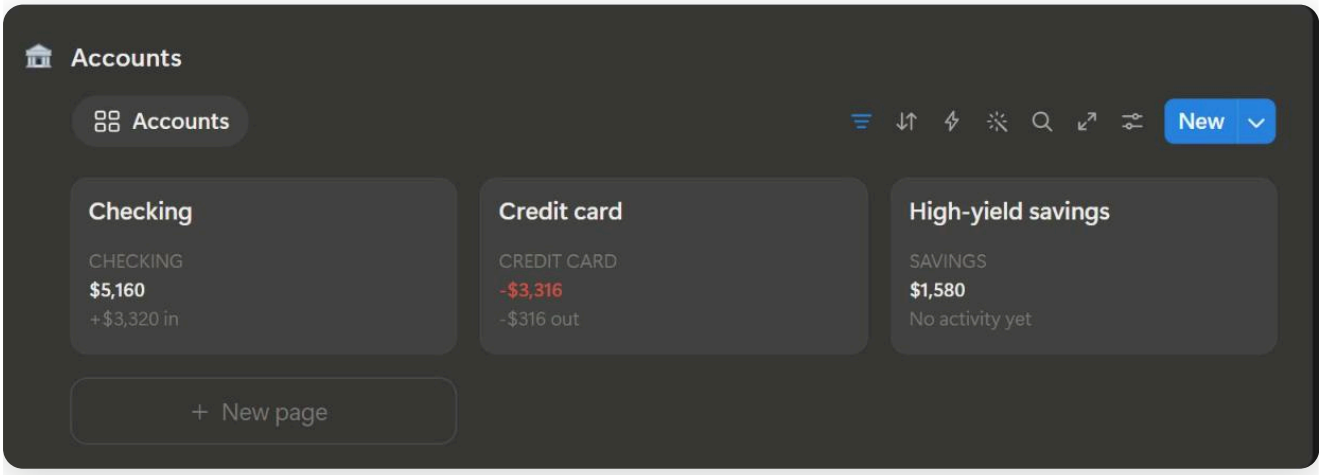


Sources: Salary, Side income, Freelance, Gifts, Refunds and Other. The name in Income sources must match the Source exactly.

Accounts Full version

Add each account with its type (Checking, Savings, Cash, Credit card or Investment) and its balance today as the **Starting balance**.

When you link income and spending to an account, its balance updates by itself: starting balance plus money in minus money out. The sum of all balances is your **net worth**.



Credit cards. Enter the amount you owe as a negative starting balance, for example −3,000.

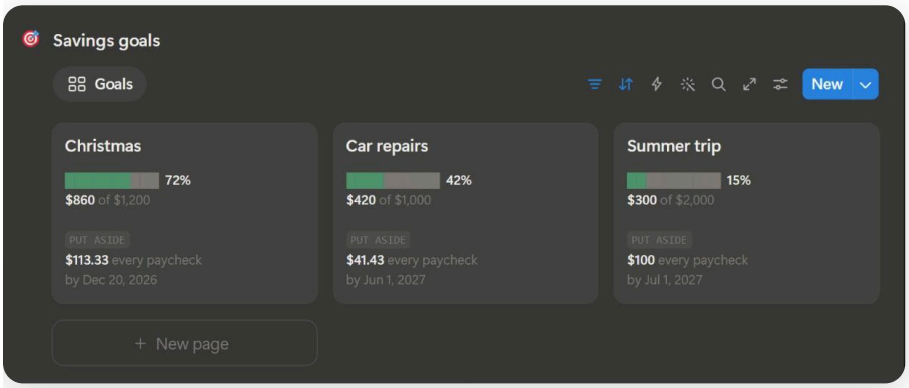
Chapter 10

Savings goals and Debt payoff

Free version. Savings and extra debt are one fixed amount per paycheck that you set yourself.

Savings goals Full version

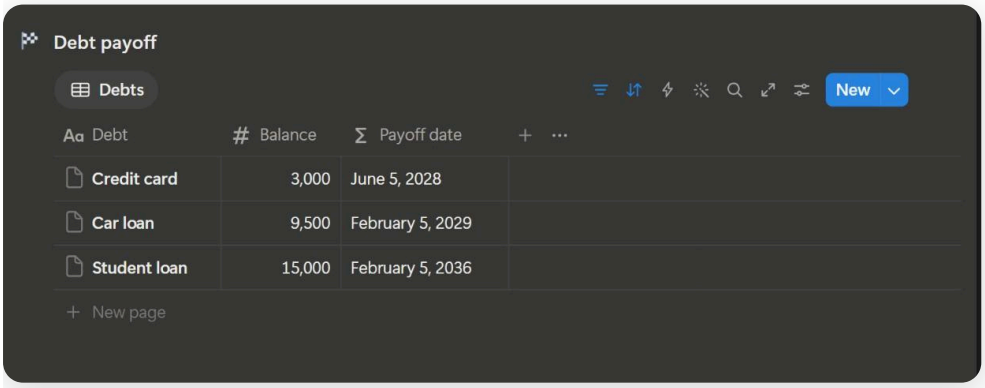
For each goal enter the **Target**, what you have **Saved** so far and the date you **Need it by**. Paycheck OS counts the paychecks until that date and tells you what to put aside every paycheck. That amount is taken off the top in This paycheck.



When you move money to savings, update **Saved**. The progress bar and the amount per paycheck adjust.

Debt payoff Full version

For each debt enter the **Balance**, **Interest rate %**, **Minimum payment** and, if you want, **Extra per month**. You see the monthly payment, the months to payoff, the payoff date and the total interest.



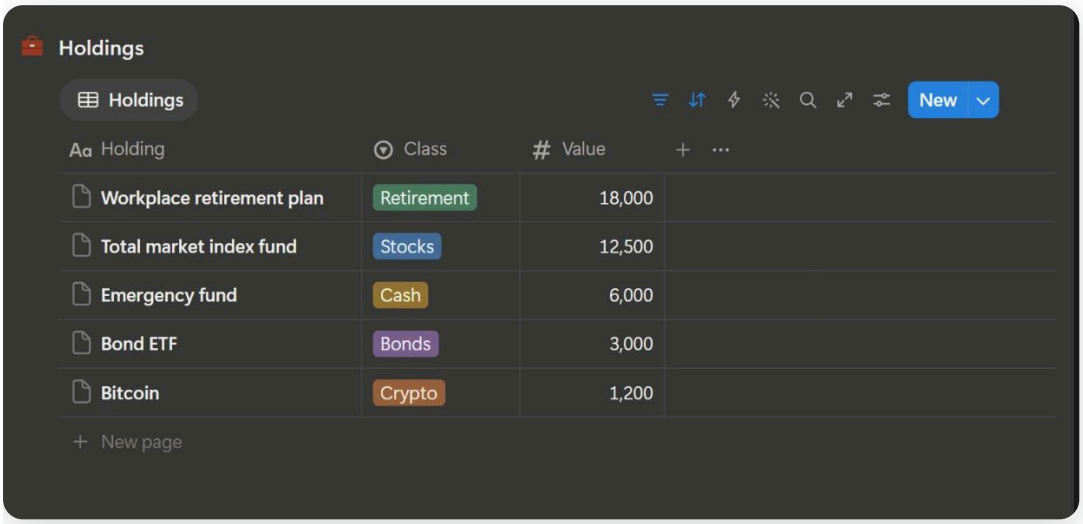
Try a bigger Extra per month and watch the payoff date move closer. The extra amount is split across your paychecks and shows as Extra to debt in This paycheck.

Chapter 11

Asset allocation and Holdings

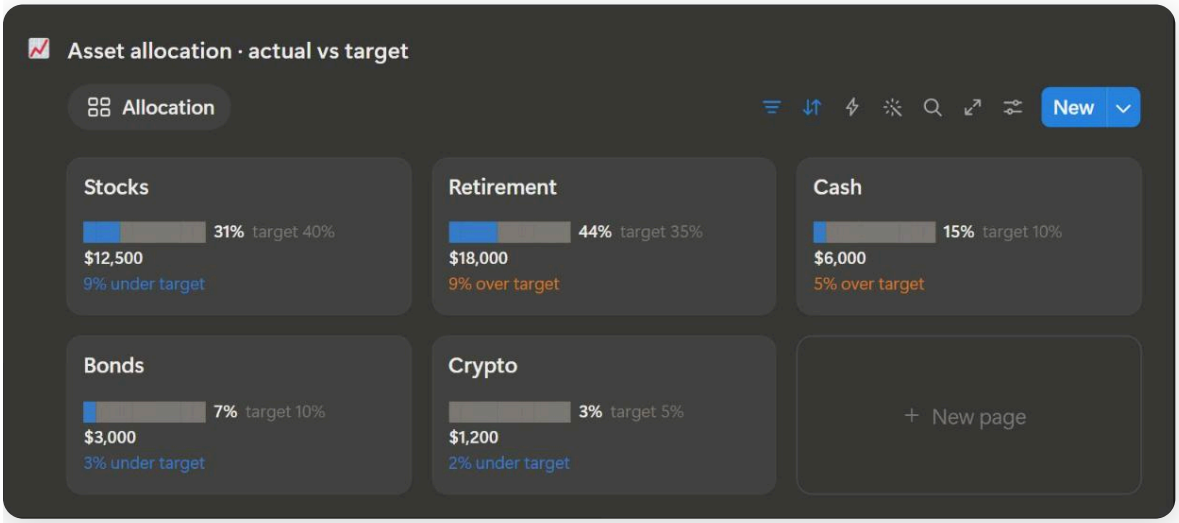
Holdings Full version

List what you own with a **Value** and a **Class**: Cash, Stocks, Bonds, Real estate, Crypto, Retirement or Other.



Asset allocation · actual vs target Full version

One row per class with your **Target %** (all targets should add up to 100). The card shows the value in each class, its real share of the total and how far it is from your target.



Update the values in Holdings now and then, for example once a month. The class names in Asset allocation must match the Holdings classes exactly.

Paycheck OS shows your own numbers. It does not give investment advice.

Chapter 12

Your data: every database

Every list in Paycheck OS lives on the Your data page. You type in the fields marked "you"; everything else is calculated.

Do not delete the My plan row or the **Plan** link on rows. Every row is connected to My plan; that is how currency and totals reach each card. New rows added from the cards are linked for you.

Database	Fields
My plan	You: Take-home pay, Pay frequency, Currency. Calculated: Next payday, Monthly income, Net worth and the totals the other cards use.
Paychecks	You: name, Pay date, Take-home override (optional). Calculated: next payday, bills due, savings, extra to debt, spent, left to spend, days left, safe per day.
Bills	You: Bill, Amount, Due day, Autopay, Category. Calculated: next due date, due in, status, paid. Button: Log payment.
Spending	You: What, Amount, Date (filled in), Category, Account.
Savings goals Full	You: Goal, Target, Saved, Need it by. Calculated: still to save, progress, paychecks left, per paycheck.
Debts Full	You: Debt, Balance, Interest rate %, Minimum payment, Extra per month. Calculated: monthly payment, months to payoff, payoff date, total interest.
Accounts Full	You: Account, Type, Starting balance. Calculated: money in, money out, balance.
Category budgets Full	You: Category (same name as in Spending), Monthly budget. Calculated: spent this month, left.
Income Full	You: What, Amount, Date, Source, Account, Invoice (file).
Income sources Full	You: Source (same name as in Income), Monthly goal. Calculated: earned this month.
Budget split Full	You: Pillar, Share of income, Includes. Calculated: budget, used.
Bill payments Full	Filled in by Log payment: Payment, Amount, Date, Bill. You can also add or delete rows by hand.
Holdings Full	You: Holding, Value, Class.
Asset allocation Full	You: Class (same name as in Holdings), Target %. Calculated: value, share.

Chapter 13

Routines

Once set up, Paycheck OS takes a few minutes per paycheck.

Every payday (2 minutes)

1. Open **Every paycheck** and add the new paycheck with its pay date.
2. Look at **This paycheck** on the Overview: bills to pay, savings to move and what is left.
3. Move the savings and extra debt payment as soon as the money lands.
4. Update **Saved** on your savings goals.

When you pay a bill

Click **Log payment** next to it. It is marked Paid until the next due date. Autopay bills need nothing.

Every day you spend

Click **New** under Spending, type what it was and the amount. Check **Safe per day** before bigger purchases.

Once a month (5 minutes)

- Check **Category budgets** and **Budget split**. Adjust limits that are always too tight or too loose.
- Look at **Month by month**: how much did you keep?
- Log income from side jobs and update **Holdings** values.
- Review **Subscriptions** and cancel what you no longer use.

When something changes

- New salary: change Take-home pay in My plan.
- One paycheck is different (overtime, bonus): enter it in **Take-home override** on that paycheck only.
- New bill or a bill ends: add or delete it in Bills.

Chapter 14

Logging from your phone

Paycheck OS works in the Notion app on iPhone and Android.

Home screen widget

1. Install the Notion app and sign in.
2. Add a Notion widget to your home screen.
3. Choose the **Spending** page. One tap opens it, then tap New.

Favorites

Open Spending in the Notion app and add it to Favorites so it is one tap away.

iPhone automation (optional)

1. In the Shortcuts app, create a shortcut that adds a page to your Spending database.
2. In Automation, choose the Wallet **Transaction** trigger and run that shortcut.
3. Every Apple Pay payment now opens a new spending entry for you to finish.

Chapter 15

Questions and fixes

Does it connect to my bank?

No. You enter amounts yourself. Nothing leaves your Notion workspace and there are no outside widgets or embeds.

Safe per day is negative

You spent more than this paycheck had left. Spend less until payday, or move money from a goal and lower its Saved amount.

This paycheck shows the wrong period

Check that the newest paycheck is added in Every paycheck with the right Pay date, and that Pay frequency in My plan is correct.

A bill is missing from Pay from this paycheck

It is due after your next payday, so it belongs to the next paycheck. Check its Due day.

A budget, income goal or allocation stays at 0

The name does not match. Budget names must match Spending categories, income sources must match Income sources, allocation classes must match Holdings classes, letter by letter.

Can I rename or add categories?

Yes. Edit the Category options in Spending, then use the same names in Category budgets and in Budget split → Includes.

Twice a month pay

Choose Twice a month in My plan and add each paycheck with its real pay date, for example the 1st and the 15th.

I bought the full version after the free one

Duplicate the full version and copy your bills, goals and spending across, or simply start fresh from your next payday.

Still stuck? Email **northlinebudget@gmail.com**. We reply within 24 hours.